

Tools and Frameworks for Analysing Social Problems

1. Problem Tree Analysis

Problem tree analysis is a visual tool that helps you identify and organize the core problem, its causes, and its consequences. You start by defining the core problem as the trunk of the tree, then you add the causes as the roots, and the consequences as the branches. This way, you can see the relationships between different aspects of the problem, and prioritize the most relevant ones. Problem tree analysis can help you clarify the scope and focus of your social impact strategy, and generate ideas for potential interventions.

2. Theory of Change

Theory of Change is a framework that helps you map out the logic and assumptions behind your social impact strategy. You start by defining your long-term goal, then you work backwards to identify the outcomes, outputs, activities, and inputs that are necessary to achieve it. You also specify the indicators and evidence that will measure your progress and impact. Theory of Change can help you articulate your vision, align your actions with your objectives, and communicate your impact to stakeholders.

3. Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholder analysis is a tool that helps you identify and understand the interests, needs, expectations, and influence of the people and organizations that are affected by or involved in your social impact strategy. You can use various methods, such as interviews, surveys, focus groups, or mapping, to collect and analyze information about your stakeholders. Stakeholder analysis can help you engage and collaborate with your stakeholders, manage their expectations, and address their concerns and feedback.

4. SWOT Analysis

SWOT analysis is a tool that helps you assess the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats of your social impact strategy. You can use a four-quadrant matrix to list and analyze the internal and external factors that affect your strategy. SWOT analysis can help you identify your competitive advantages, improve your performance, explore new opportunities, and mitigate potential risks.

5. Impact Evaluation

Impact evaluation is a framework that helps you measure and analyze the effects of your social impact strategy on your target population and the wider society. You can use various methods, such as experiments, quasi-experiments, or case studies, to collect and analyze data on the outcomes and impacts of your strategy. Impact evaluation can help you demonstrate your accountability, learn from your experience, and improve your decision-making.

*aims to establish a cause-and-effect relationship between an independent and dependent variable

Social Problem Analysis

Analyse a social problem of significant concern to you

- Describe the problem, competing perspectives on the issues and groups impacted.

- Contributing factors to the cause of the problem.
- Prevention efforts to reduce or eliminate the problem.
- Solution(s) and challenges that may impact the proposed solution(s).
- Why in your opinion should society be concerned about this issue?
- What role do you envision yourself playing as a social worker in addressing this issue?

